



NEXTBILLION.AI

(ENTERPRISE-GRADE MAPPING SOLUTIONS)

- **SHAOLIN ZHENG**, CO-FOUNDER
- **GAURAV BUBNA**, CO-FOUNDER
- **AJAY BULUSU**, CO-FOUNDER

> **KEY INVESTORS** CLightspeed, Alphawave, Microsoft's Venture Fund (M12), Mirae Asset

> **FUNDING** \$37.3 million so far

► **NextBillion.ai**, conceived by Gaurav Bubna, Ajay Bulusu, and Shaolin Zheng, is rewriting the rules of enterprise mapping. Having cut their teeth at Grab, a heavyweight in South-East Asia's ride-sharing arena, they mastered their craft by building maps from the ground up, delving into the complexities of enterprise mapping. The spark for NextBillion.ai was ignited when they realised that one standardised map falls short in a world teeming with diverse needs. They envisioned a future where geospatial control is decentralised, placing users in command of their own map stacks. Kicking off operations in February 2020, it found itself at a pivotal moment. As businesses grappled with survival during Covid-19, its solution emerged as the unsung hero, helping companies optimise logistics and supply chains. "We provide enterprise-grade, fully managed map data and APIs. Our product addresses hyper-local nuances and provides solutions for specific business needs based on company data and geography," the founders say. According to the company, the US market accounts for more than 60 per cent of its revenue and it expanded its customer base from 14 in 2022 to 75+ in 2023. **BT**

— BY **BINU PAUL**

► **AROUND 2015**, WHEN Swapnil Jain, a fresh graduate from IIT Delhi started working at X (then Twitter), he noticed how the micro-blogging platform was often used for customer complaints—hinting at the broken call centre industry processes. Soon, he quit his job and found himself exploring things from ground zero in the Philippines, the call centre hub of the world. He spent two years doing just that and in August 2017, Observe.AI was born. Jithendra Vepa joined a year later. Today it serves 200+ businesses in industries ranging from finserve and healthcare, among others. "We only sell in the North American markets right now since our customers are very large enterprises who will pay us anywhere from \$200,000 to \$5 million because for our product to be successful, we need someone with a large number of customer care agents," says Jain. The company turned in revenues of \$24 million in FY23.

Observe.AI provides a live conversation intelligence platform for contact centres and its 30-billion-parameter Contact Center Large Language Model, and the newly introduced Generative AI Suite aims to elevate agent performance throughout customer interactions. In contrast to generic models like GPT, Observe.AI's proprietary LLM is trained on domain-specific datasets. **BT**

— BY **PRERNA LIDHOO**

OBSERVE.AI (WORKFORCE PLATFORM)

- **SWAPNIL JAIN**, CEO & CO-FOUNDER • **JITHENDRA VEPA**, CTO & CO-FOUNDER

> **KEY INVESTORS** It has 22 institutional investors including SoftBank Vision Fund, Scale Ventures, Menlo Ventures, Nexus Venture Partners, and Y Combinator

> **FUNDING** It has raised \$213 million in funding over five rounds

> **WHAT MAKES IT COOL** It is one of those rare companies that has its own vertical AI stack

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